

subject, with the comments of a scholar who carries the utmost weight.¹ Of a more technical character is the very full discussion by Prof. Williams Jackson and Dr L. H. Gray.² Dr Gray gives us a careful summary in his excellent article on the Achæmenians.³ With researches of outstanding importance available for every reader, I may content myself with merely stating my own view and offering a few comments.

We begin with Cyrus. His position might seem to be removed from the range of discussion by the summary dictum of Prof. Eduard Meyer that "it cannot be doubted by any unprejudiced mind that Cyrus was a Zoroastrian."⁴ It will be seen from his words quoted below that this is mainly an inference from the Zoroastrianism of Darius, which Meyer asserts is patent from every word of his Inscription. The specialists are by no means so clear about Darius, and in the case of Cyrus it is hardly too much to say that the "prejudice" which Meyer's dictum implies in any who question it seems to have afflicted them with distressing uniformity. Dr L. H. Gray remarks that "there is no evidence whatever to show that he was a Zoroastrian." Dr Casartelli records the doubt whether Cyrus was an "Auramazdean" like Darius, since—

The Assyrian cuneiform inscriptions of that famous conqueror portray him rather as a polytheist, inasmuch as he proclaims himself to the Babylonians the servant and

¹ *The Religion of the Great Kings* (Catholic Truth Society).

² *Journal of the American Oriental Society*, xxi. (1901), p. 164-184.

³ *ERE*, i. 69-72 (1908).

⁴ *Enc. Brit.*, xxi. 205 : cf. *Gesch. d. Alt.*, iii. 21 (" . . . wird, wer die Sachlage besonnen überlegt, nicht bezweifeln; sonst müsste die Religion bei Darius als Neuerung auftreten").